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YWCA women of Distinction Award
Category: Young Woman of Distinction

Re: Recommendation of Stephanie Slen

Dear Members of the Award Committee,

I am writing to wholeheartedly recommend Stephanie Slen for the Young Woman of Distinction award. I first met Stephanie in 2019 when I was the Executive Director of Fresh Roots Urban Farm Society. Stephanie was a youth participant in the SOYL program. Over the next five years I had the privilege of witnessing firsthand Stephanie's own tremendous personal leadership development as she returned to Fresh Roots to take on youth leadership roles with increasing responsibility. Her commitment to supporting peers and contributing to her community in diverse and outstanding ways was demonstrated at every turn.

Throughout the time I have worked and known Stephanie, she never ceases to amaze me with the type of challenges and volunteerism they take on. I especially appreciate Stephanie's openness to learning and how she shares and engages with peers and others in her community in ways that support and uplift. After her season as a youth participant Stephanie chose to return to Fresh Roots SOYL program as a mentor in 2020. Amidst the global pandemic and a notably challenging year for many youth, Stephanie stretched her leadership skills. She became an important youth leader for the cohort, leading by example with her positive attitude, strong work ethic and her deeply caring and patient nature.

Stephanie's tenacity, humility, commitment to justice and to her own personal learning and development is truly inspirational. Her impact on the lives of so many Fresh Roots youth participants cannot be understated.

Knowing Stephanie gives me hope for the future. I cannot imagine a more deserving recipient for the Young Woman of Distinction Award. Should you require any further information, please feel free to contact me at 778-883-2599.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Alexa Pitoulis'.

Alexa Pitoulis
Executive Director
BC Family Doctors

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